

GHENT
UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY SERVICES – RESEARCH

AS OPEN AS POSSIBLE, AS CLOSED AS NECESSARY

balancing Open Science and valorisation in your funding proposal, May 20, 2026

GHENT UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY SERVICES – RESEARCH
TEAM OPEN SCIENCE

AS OPEN AS POSSIBLE …

GHENT
UNIVERSITY



Components of Open Science

GHENT UNIVERSITY

👉 Source: https://opusproject.eu/openscience-news/unleashing-the-power-of-open-science-exploring-essential-tools-and-technologies/

GROWING EXPECTATIONS FOR OPEN SCIENCE POLICY AND REQUIREMENTS

FWO Open Access Journal articles — 2007

2012 — FP7 Open Access pilot

H2020 Mandatory open access to publications — 2014

H2020 Start of Open Research Data (ORD) pilot

2015 — First announcement of European Open Science Cloud

UGent Policy Framework on RDM — 2016

2017 — ORD pilot extended to all Horizon 2020 areas

FWO policy on research data management — 2018

2019 — **Revised BOF regulation includes data as research output**

2020 — **UGent Education & Examination code Mandatory DMP for starting PhDs**

2021 — Horizon Europe Mandatory and recommended OS and RDM practices

FWO reporting policy for research results — 2022

Use of Flemish Standard DMP for FWO/VLAIO-cSBO

New UGent Policy on Scholarly Publishing — 2023

Dataset registration in Biblio

FWO reporting of journal articles via FRIS — 2024

Launch of the EOSC EU node

Stricter monitoring of FWO reporting procedure and policy — 2025

GHENT UNIVERSITY

https://www.ugent.be/en/research/datamanagement/policies/overview.htm
https://www.ugent.be/en/research/openscience/schol-publishing/oa-funder-requirements.htm

OPEN SCIENCE IN APPLICATIONS FOR FWO RESEARCH PROJECTS

How do I address **open science** in FWO my proposal?

Open science (OS) takes a central place in FWO's research policy. Open science practices are considered in the evaluation of FWO proposals for junior and senior fundamental research projects. Open and FAIR science principles as well as how research is made transparant and reproducible are evaluated.

CV

List main research results, achievements, scientific output and impact. Include **publications**, **datasets**, **research software**, **grey literature** and **other research outputs** of the project partners relevant to the project proposal.

- Include open publications and datasets
- Include other research outputs
- Include persistent identifiers when available

Research methodology and workplan

Open Science

Describe how OS practices are integrated into the methodology and adapted to your work to support project objectives. Include mandatory practices and, where relevant, recommended ones. If none apply, provide justification.

Mandatory OS practices

- Open access to journal articles
- Data management planning
- Reporting of research results
- Data preservation for at least 5 years

Recommended OS practices

- Management of research data in line with FAIR principles
- Access to research data, as open as possible, as closed as necessary
- Open access to other publications
- Sharing of research output (beyond publications and data)

FAIR data principles

Describe how existing data is re-used
Describe how new data will be made FAIR.
Describe how data will be shared as open as possible, as closed as necessary. If data cannot be shared, provide justification.

Tips

- Explain how you will make your research transparent and reproducible.
- Describe how you will dessiminate your research. Make sure proposed practices are compatible with your dissemination and exploitation plan (e.g. protection of intellectual property) and (contractual) agreements.

Other sections

- Include data sharing in the data management section
- Include resources for OS practices in the Requested Funding section.
- Any other section of proposal

For more info on FWO's research policy, check the FWO website

GHENT UNIVERSITY

Download: https://osf.io/2kdve/files/p7wt3

OPEN ACCESS TO PUBLICATIONS

GHENT
UNIVERSITY

Opendefinition.org

Open means anyone can freely access, use, modify, and share for any purpose (subject, at most, to requirements that preserve provenance and openness).”

GHENT UNIVERSITY

BENEFITS OF OPEN ACCESS



GHENT UNIVERSITY

OPEN ACCESS IN FWO PROPOSALS

No Open Access obligations!



However, show how you already practice Open Access:

→ Ensure open access to publications in your publications list, where possible.

→ How? You can make your peer reviewed journal articles open access in Biblio.

Include Open Access

→ In your budget: costs associated with OA publishing can be charged as bench fees as part of beneficiaries' FWO funding.

→ in your publication strategy

GHENT UNIVERSITY

PLAN YOUR PUBLICATION STRATEGY

- Why do you publish? Peer review, dissemination, requirement, …
- What will you publish (peer reviewed article, book, abstract, blog, …)
- When in the publication process (collaborative writing - preprint – postprint)
- How will you publish? (open) peer review, licensing, collaboration acknowledgement, …
- Where will you publish? Journal with IF, open access journal, certain publisher, ..

Include Open Access considerations

GHENT UNIVERSITY

OPEN ACCESS REQUIREMENTS

§ 2. Following the Berlin Declaration of 2003 for the promotion of free access to scientific knowledge and cultural heritage, beneficiaries of FWO fellowships, grants and projects must deposit the publications resulting in whole or in part from the FWO subsidies,

in a public “Open Access” database, → use Biblio

in accordance with the provisions of Art. XI.196, §2/1 of the Code of Economic Law, → Gold OA (OA journal) / → Green OA (AAM in database)

within one year from the date of publication, → open AAM in Biblio after embargo period

in order to effect greater impact and valorisation of their work. The FWO derives the Open Access definition from the aforementioned Berlin Declaration and therefore expects worldwide and free online access to the above-mentioned publications for everyone, both within and outside the scientific context. Researchers are also advised to publish their other publications in such an "Open Access" database, the so-called "Open Archives", together with the research data that resulted in these publications.

GHENT UNIVERSITY

👉 Source: FWO general regulations

👉 See also Open Access: how?

SOME NUANCE

→ “Although the FWO recommends that researchers publish all publications in Open Access form, the current regulations apply only and strictly to peer-reviewed journal articles (A1)”

→ “The FWO accepts a maximum embargo period of 12 months, which since 2018 has also been implemented in a federal law”

Belgian OA legislation

→ “Any costs that may be associated with publishing in Open Access can be charged as bench fees as part of the FWO funding. This applies not only to peer-reviewed journal articles (A1) but also to other types of publications, such as books.”

Gold OA APCs are eligible costs

GHENT UNIVERSITY

👉 Source: Research Policy – Open Access

HOW TO PROVIDE OPEN ACCESS



Repository (AAM)

→ **Self archiving**: the author archives a publication in an openly available repository (Green Open Access).



Publishing venue (license)

→ **Open Access publishing**: publish immediately in Open Access (Gold APC Open Access, Diamond Open Access)

→ **Hybrid publishing**: pay to open only your article in a subscription journal (APC).

GHENT UNIVERSITY

👉 More on Open Access: how?

GREEN OPEN ACCESS

UNIVERSITEIT GENT

ACADEMIC BIBLIOGRAPHY

Add publications and datasets Lists (31) Inge Van Nieuwerburgh

Search 200 years of publications by Ghent University researchers.

Search publications and datasets Advanced search

Recently added research

New open access publications and datasets

Ghent University has a policy setting out its vision and guidelines for scholarly publishing.

- → Protéger l'emploi en temps de crise : efficacité et limites du chômage temporaire en Be...
- → Jobs beschermen in tijden van crisis met tijdelijke werkloosheid : lessen uit onderzoek
- → Perceived product management priorities in software startups : a data-driven reduction ...
- → MuMax3 Source for Numerical Calculation of the Hopf Index for 3D Magnetic Textures
- → Prioritizing binary mixtures of metals with organic micropollutants in European freshw...
- → World Flora Online Plant List December 2025

View all open access publications and datasets.



Photo by Alessandro Bianchi on Unsplash

Connected with ORCID

ORCID provides a persistent identifier that will distinguish you from other researchers throughout your scholarly career.

- → Protéger l'emploi en temps de crise : efficacité et limites du chômage temporaire en Be...
- → Jobs beschermen in tijden van crisis met tijdelijke werkloosheid : lessen uit onderzoek
- → Le chômage temporaire en Belgique : un outil efficace et bénéfique, à condition d'en ma...
- → Metin SÖNMEZ, George HEWITT (eds.), 2022. Abkhazia 1992-2022: Reflections on Abkhazia, ...
- → A modeling approach to predict population-level impact of silver (Ag) to rainbow trout ...

New PhD dissertations

- → Unveiling the hidden role of bacteria in pollinator insects
- → Tracing bodily immaterialities : translations of embodied knowledge in immersive worlds
- → Eliciting consumers' preference tradeoffs in food choice : experimental evidence from h...
- → Flight control of flapping-wing micro air vehicles using CFD simulations and reinforcem...
- → Meaningful activities 4 all : direct support professionals' perspectives on enabling me...

All PhD dissertations

GHENT UNIVERSITY

SPECIFIC LAW



Author can deposit

Author Accepted Manuscript (**AAM**)

of **peer-reviewed journal article**

open access

after **embargo** period (6/12 months)

according to B**elgian law.**

GHENT UNIVERSITY

👉 More details

AUTHOR ACCEPTED MANUSCRIPT

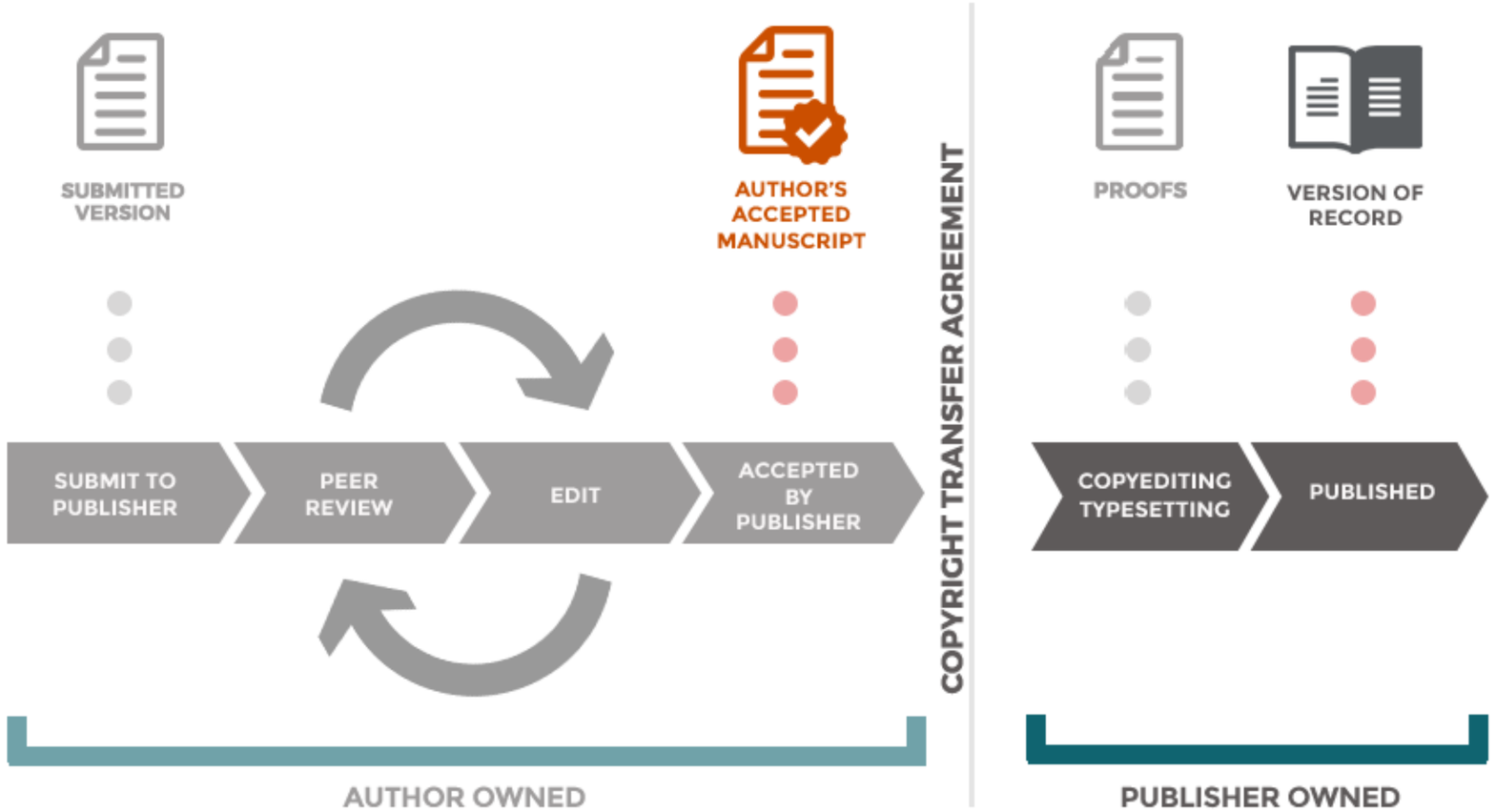


Image from M. Garnier (March 27, 2018), Manuscript detectives - submitted, accepted, or published? Licenced under CC BY 4.0

GHENT UNIVERSITY

RDM

GHENT
UNIVERSITY

DATA ARE FIRST-CLASS RESEARCH OUTPUT



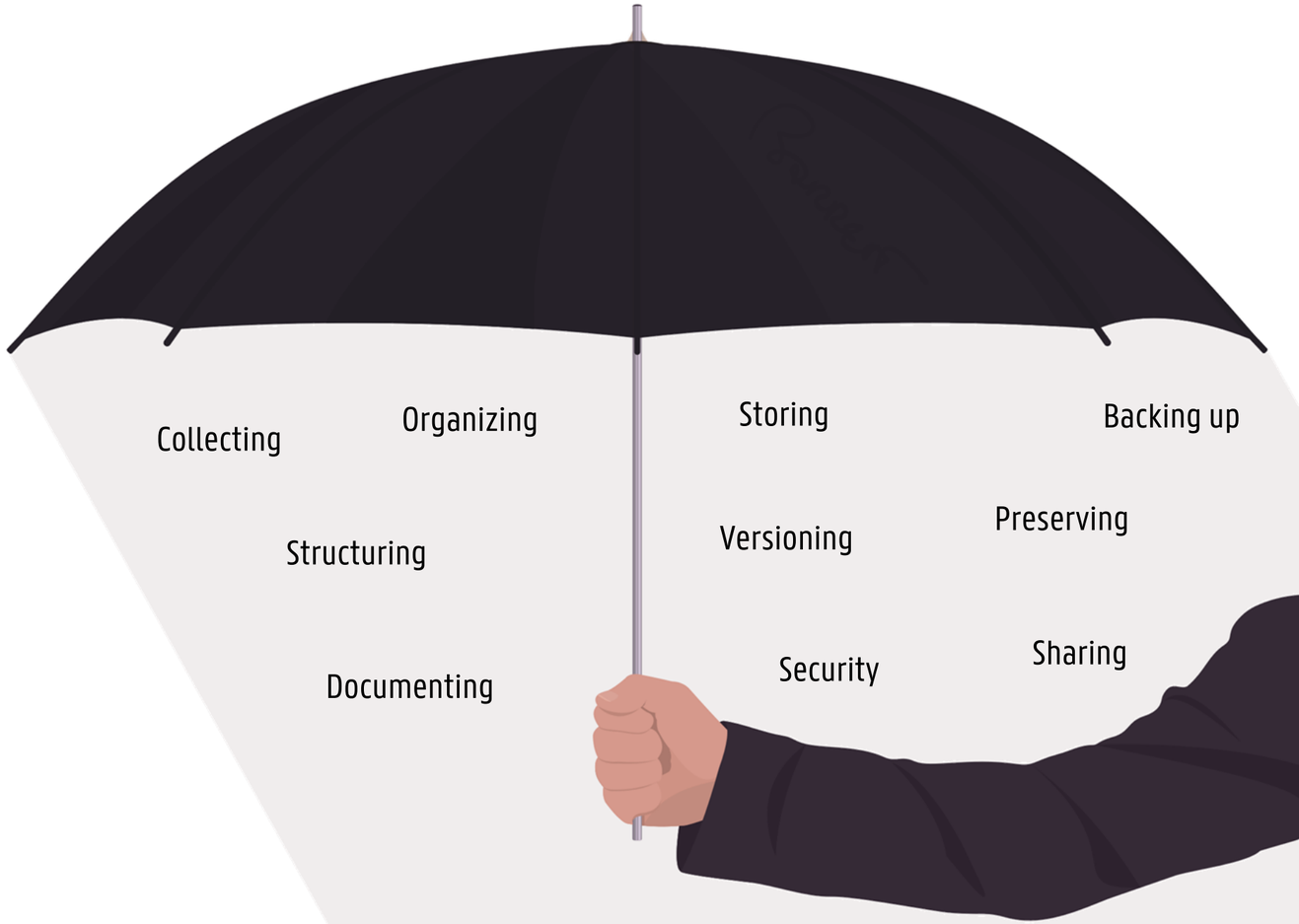
PUBLICATIONS AND DATA

GHENT UNIVERSITY

WHAT IS RESEARCH DATA MANAGEMENT (RDM)?

- Actions to **take care of data during the course of research and beyond**.
- An integral part of research.

"the compilation of many small practices that make your data easier to understand, less likely to be lost, and more likely to be usable during a project or ten years later" (Briney 2015)



GHENT UNIVERSITY

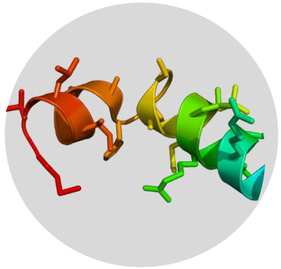
Adapted from 'RDM: An Overview' by Research Support Team, IT Services (University of Oxford), licensed under CC-BY-NC-SA 4.0 and OpenClipart CC BY

RESEARCH DATA CAN MEAN A LOT

Survey



Measurement



Observation



Code



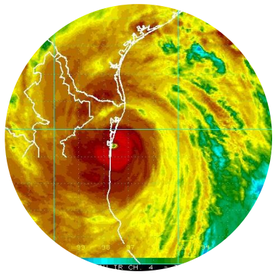
Image



Document



Visualisation

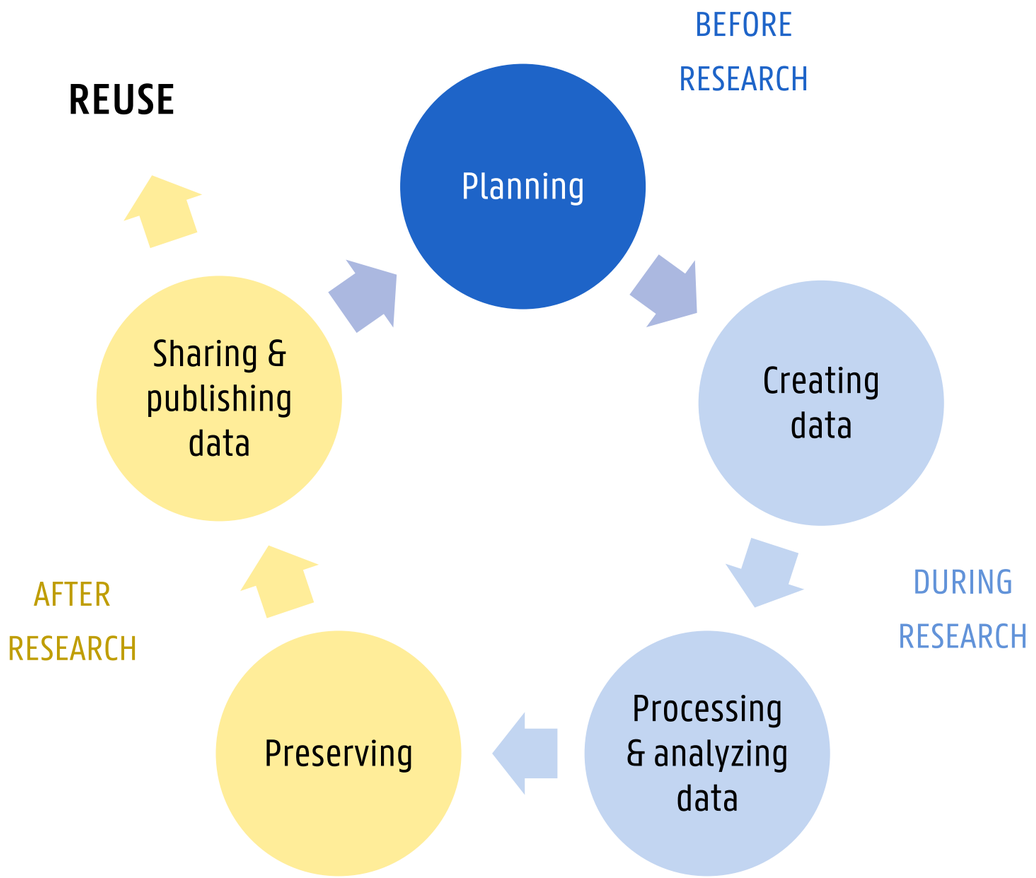


Research data is **any information** that has been collected, observed, generated or created **to validate original research findings**.

GHENT UNIVERSITY

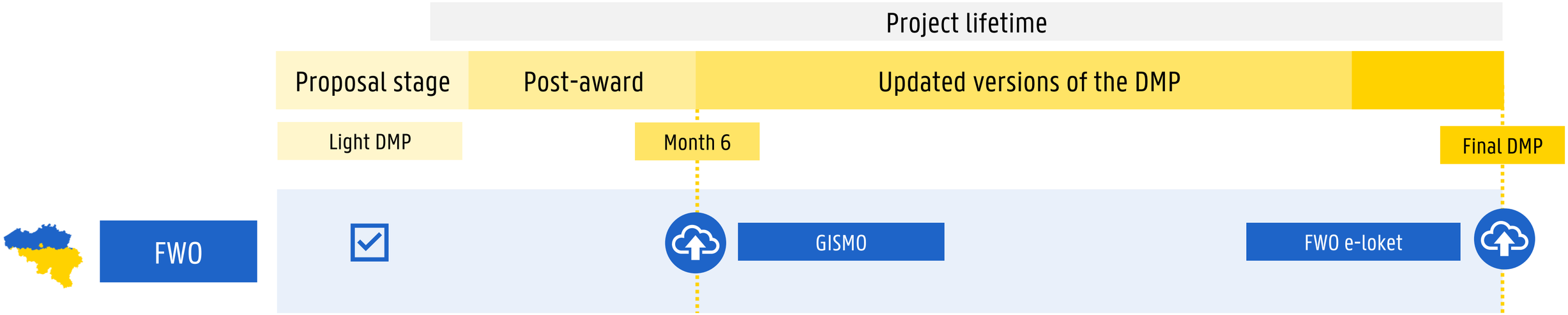
DATA MANAGEMENT PLAN (DMP)

- Outlines **which research data** is used, generated and collected
- Outlines how research data will be handled **during** & **after** a project.
- As a **first step** towards good **research data management** (RDM)
- A tool to
  - increase **awareness of RDM**
  - comply **with legal, ethical & other requirements**
  - identify **support & resources**
  - clarify **expectations & responsibilities**



GHENT UNIVERSITY

WRITE A DATA MANAGEMENT PLAN (DMP)



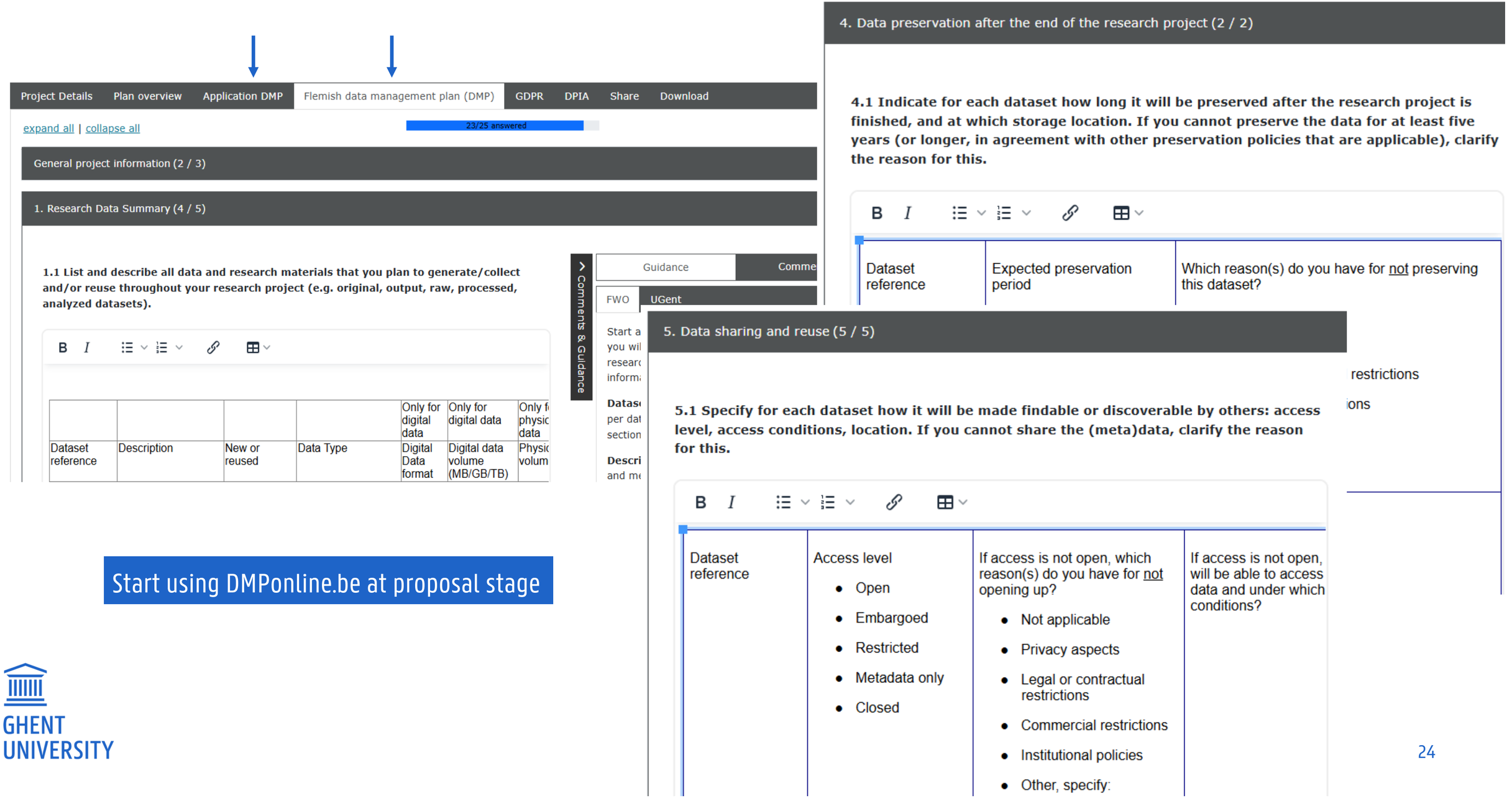
Proposal stage

- 'DMP-light': 6 RDM questions in FWO application form
- Description of the data types, preservation strategy, data security measures and data sharing approach
- The evaluation panels and external referees (for programs with external peer review) that assess the applications also inspect this part of the proposal.

Final DMP

- Precise description of all research data with persistent identifiers
- Data repositories used to share/preserve the data
- Details on how the data is documented
- Argumentation why data is not open
- Use of correct DMP template and whether the DMP is up-to-date is checked as part of the evaluation of the report

FLEMISH DMP TEMPLATE IS MANDATORY



Start using DMPonline.be at proposal stage

GHENT UNIVERSITY

DATA SHARING IN RDM

- Sharing data
  - → from completed (parts of) research projects
  - → outside your project or research team
- For whom might the data be useful?
  - researchers
  - other stakeholders
- How will you share the data? - recommended
  - Data repository
  - FAIR and open data

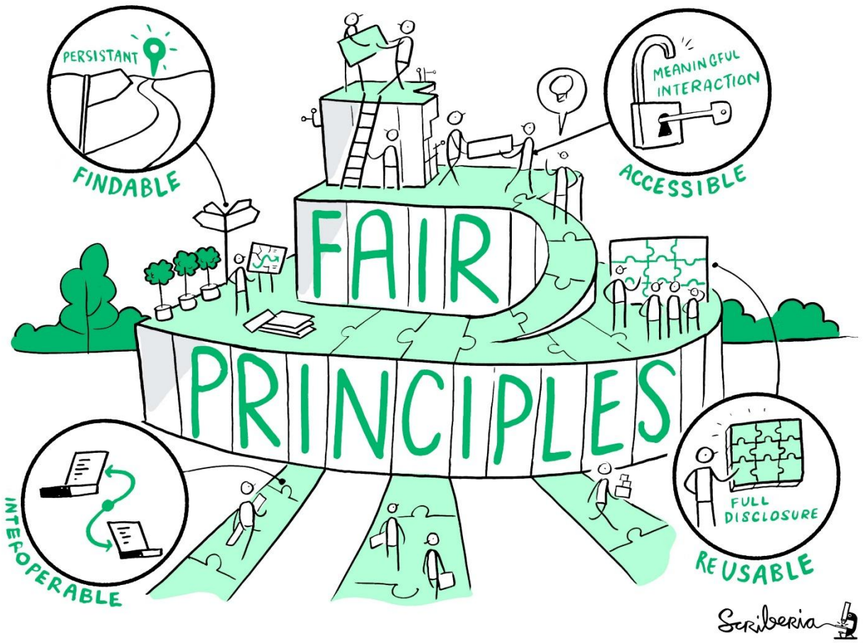


https://www.ugent.be/en/research/openscience/datamanagement/after-research/sharing.htm
https://www.fwo.be/en/about-fwo/research-policy/research-results/
https://www.fwo.be/en/about-fwo/research-policy/data-management-plan-dmp/

GHENT UNIVERSITY

WHY WERE THE FAIR DATA PRINCIPLES CREATED?

- Researchers need better infrastructure to share & reuse data
- Not just about humans: machines need to find, understand and use data too (automatically)
- The FAIR principles are guidelines to make data easier to find, share and use by both humans & machines



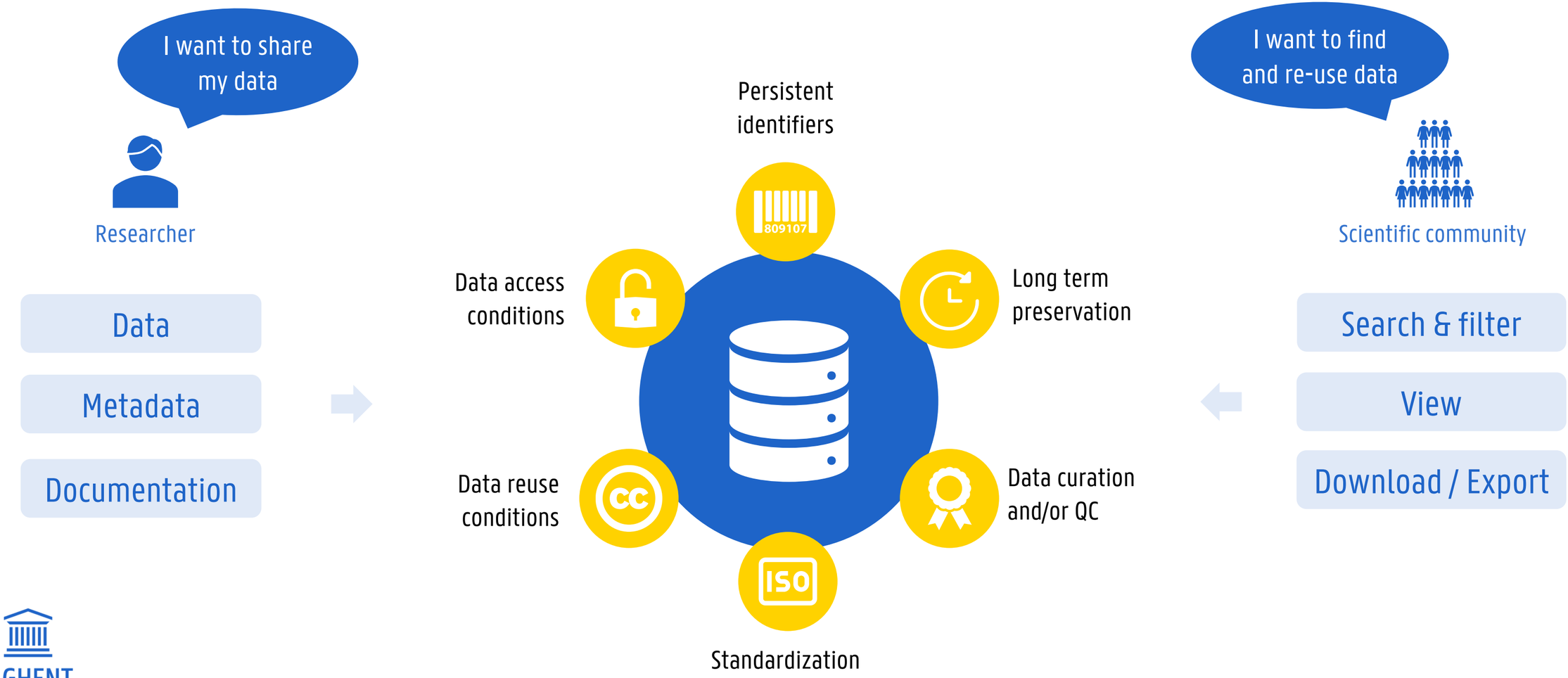
The Turing Way Community, & Scriberia. (2020, March 3). Illustrations from the Turing Way book dashes. Zenodo. http://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.3695300, CCBY

GHENT UNIVERSITY

Wilkinson, M., Dumontier, M., Aalbersberg, I. *et al.* The FAIR Guiding Principles for scientific data management and stewardship. *Sci Data* **3,** 160018 (2016). https://doi.org/10.1038/sdata.2016.18

DATA REPOSITORIES TO HELP YOU GENERATE FAIR DATA

A database infrastructure that collects, manages and stores data for preservation and sharing



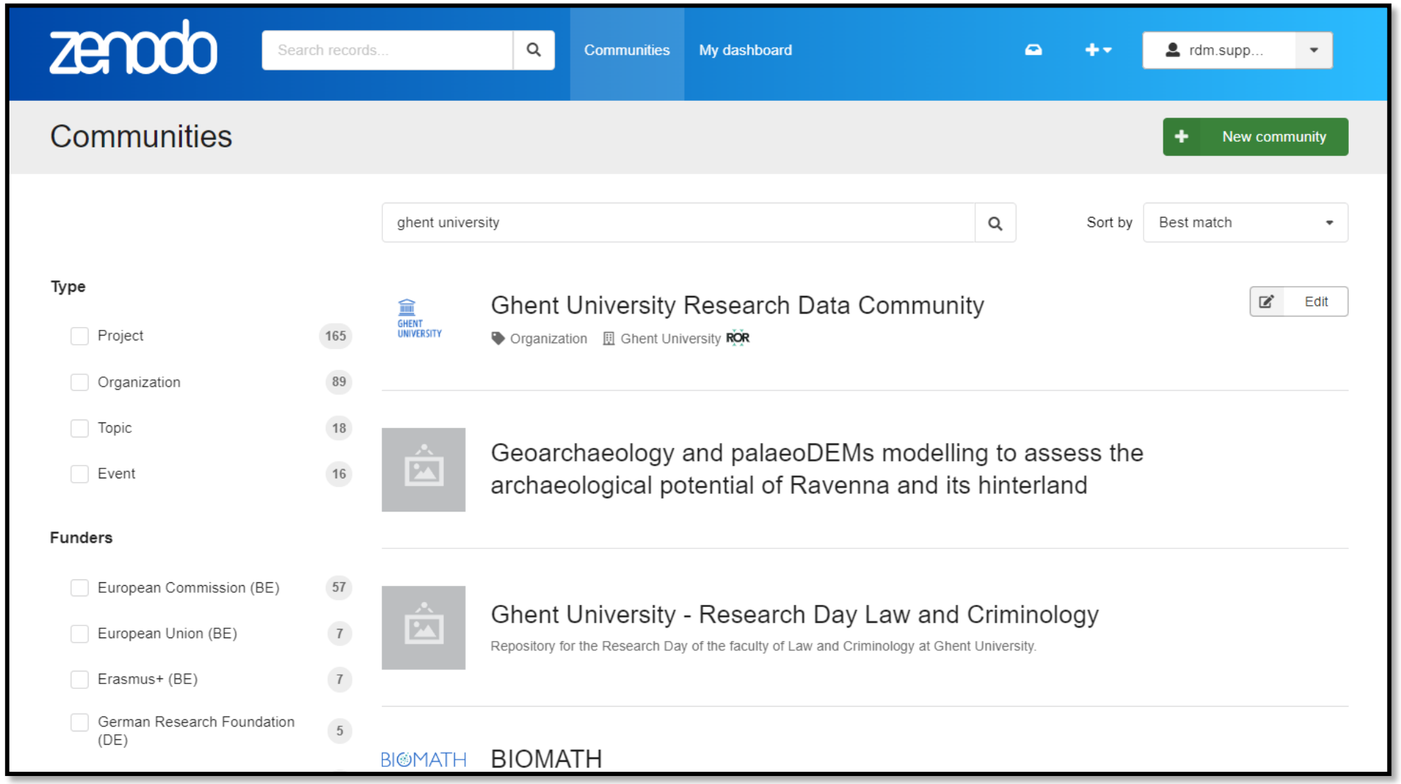
GHENT UNIVERSITY

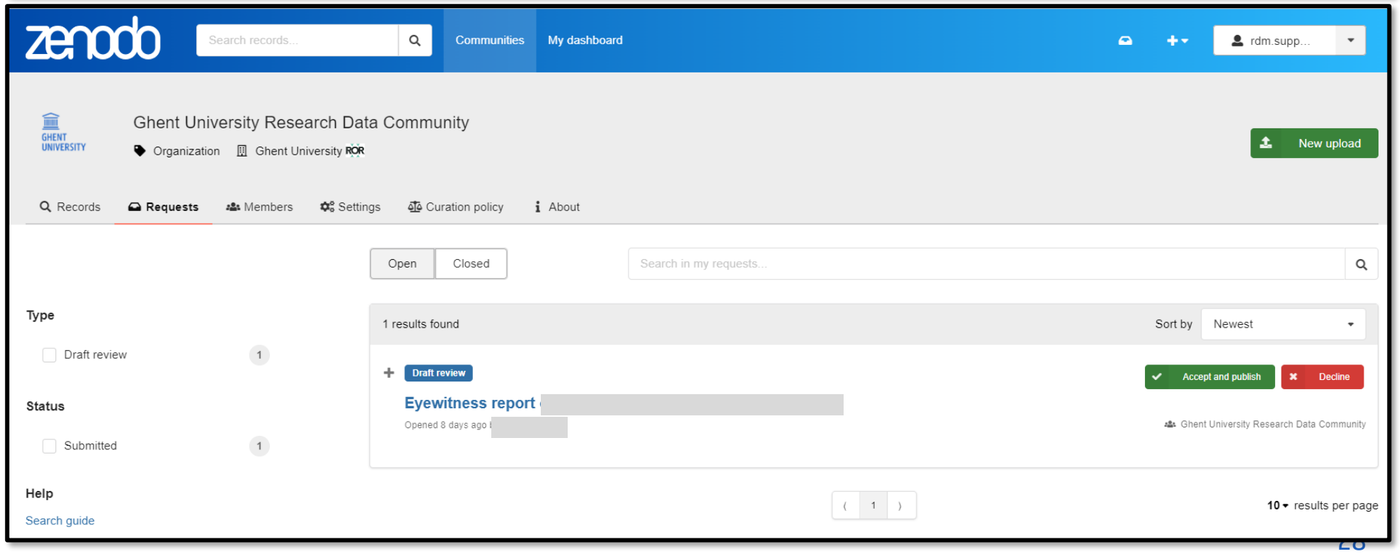
How to preserve and share data in data repositories?

ZENODO COMMUNITIES

- Collects all output of the community
- Curators of the community ensure qualitative data deposits
- Avoid spam filters in searches
- Records can be added to multiple communities

- Example: Ghent University Research Data Community
- Zenodo: step-by-step guide for preservation and sharing of research data and software

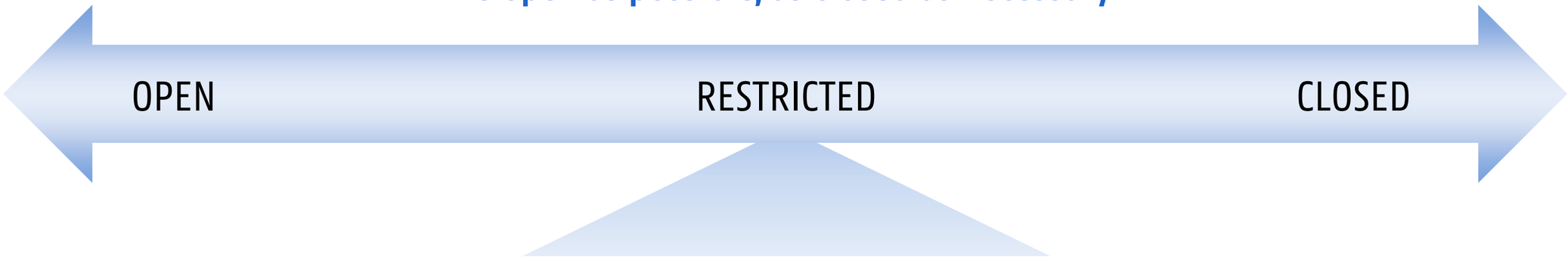




GHENT UNIVERSITY

FAIR DATA ≠ OPEN DATA

As open as possible, as closed as necessary



Can be freely used, modified & shared by anyone for any purpose

- Personal data
- Confidential data
- Sensitive data
- 3rd party data
- Copyright/database right
- Valorization potential
- Research security

Under embargo
Unable to share

If open access is not provided (to some or all data), this must be justified in the DMP

GHENT UNIVERSITY

SUPPORT

GHENT
UNIVERSITY

Team Open Science at Ghent University



Coordination

Research Data Management

Data stewards

Data curators

Scholarly publishing and Open Access

“To facilitate access to and reuse of research publications & data and promote open science practices.”

boekentoren.gent/en/library/researching/open-science

BK | UNIVERSITEIT GENT



BKT TEAM OPEN SCIENCE

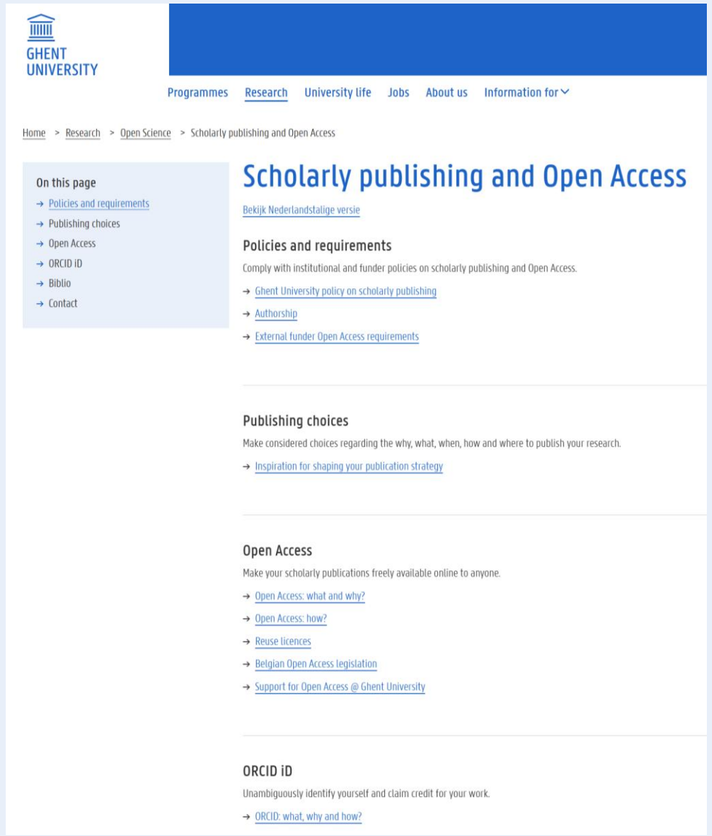
→ Helpdesk academic bibliography

→ RDM support

→ Open science support

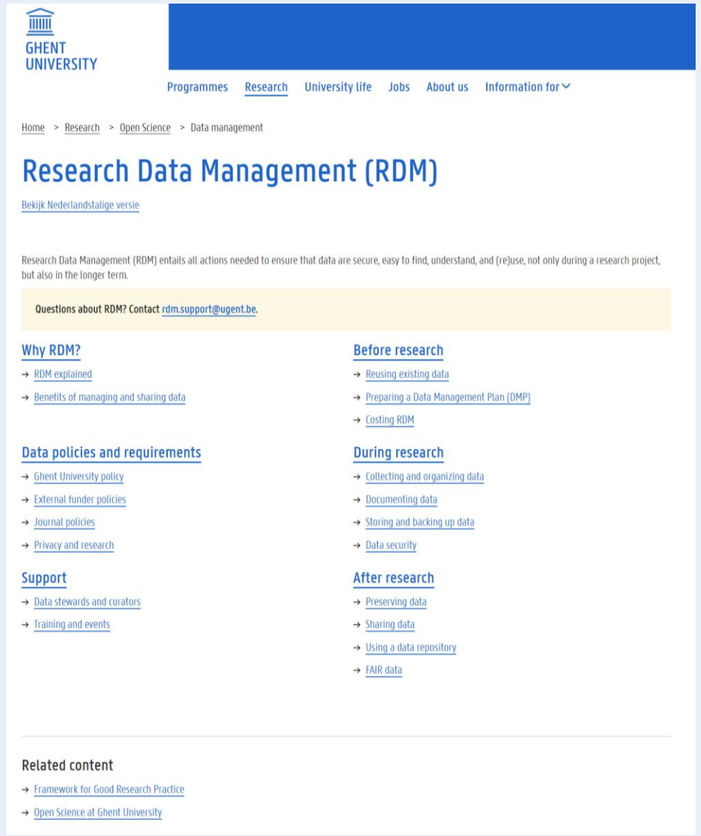
GHENT UNIVERSITY

SUPPORT



[Scholarly publishing and open access website](#)

openscience@ugent.be



[RDM website](#)

rdm.support@ugent.be



[Biblio research tips](#)

biblio.support@ugent.be

GHENT UNIVERSITY

GhentCORR on Viva Engage

Join the GhentCORR community on Viva Engage to connect, learn and collaborate on Open and Reproducible Research



We are a grassroots community dedicated to making research more impactful by fostering open and reproducible practices. We provide a space to engage, connect, inspire and support each other.

https://engage.cloud.microsoft/main/org/ugent.be/groups/eyJfdHlwZSI6Ikdyb3VwIiwiaWQiOiIyMDMyOTYzNDIwMTYifQ

Inge Van Nieuwerburgh & Stefanie De Bodt

UNIVERSITY SERVICES – RESEARCH
TEAM OPEN SCIENCE

www.ugent.be

openscience@ugent.be / rdm.support@ugent.be / biblio.support@ugent.be
@ugentopenscience.bsky.social
boekentoren.gent/UGent_OS
ugentbe.sharepoint.com/UGent_OS_training
youtube.com/UGent_OS

GHENT
UNIVERSITY

UGENT TECHTRANSFER

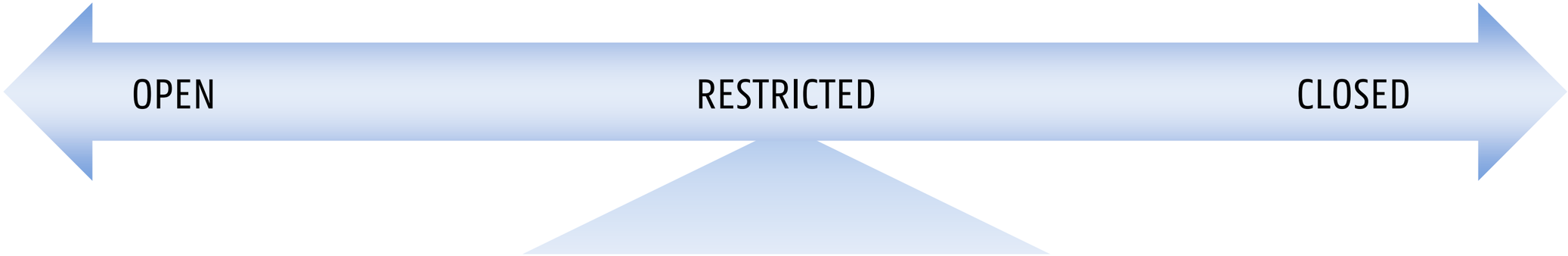
AS CLOSED AS NECESSARY

SBO-PROPOSALS

Balancing open science and valorisation in your funding proposal

GHENT UNIVERSITY

AS OPEN AS POSSIBLE... AS CLOSED AS NECESSARY



Can be freely used, modified & shared by anyone for any purpose

- Personal data
- Confidential data
- Sensitive data
- 3rd party data
- Copyright/database right
- Valorization potential
- Research security

Under embargo
Unable to share

GHENT UNIVERSITY

Definition

Open means anyone can freely access, use, modify, and share **for any purpose** (subject, at most, to requirements that preserve provenance and openness)."

Intellectual property rights (IPR) are legal frameworks—such as patents, trademarks, and copyrights—that prevent **unauthorized** use or copying of these creations.

GHENT
UNIVERSITY

WHAT IS IPR? WHAT IS FTO?

GHENT
UNIVERSITY

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

What does ownership mean?



Material



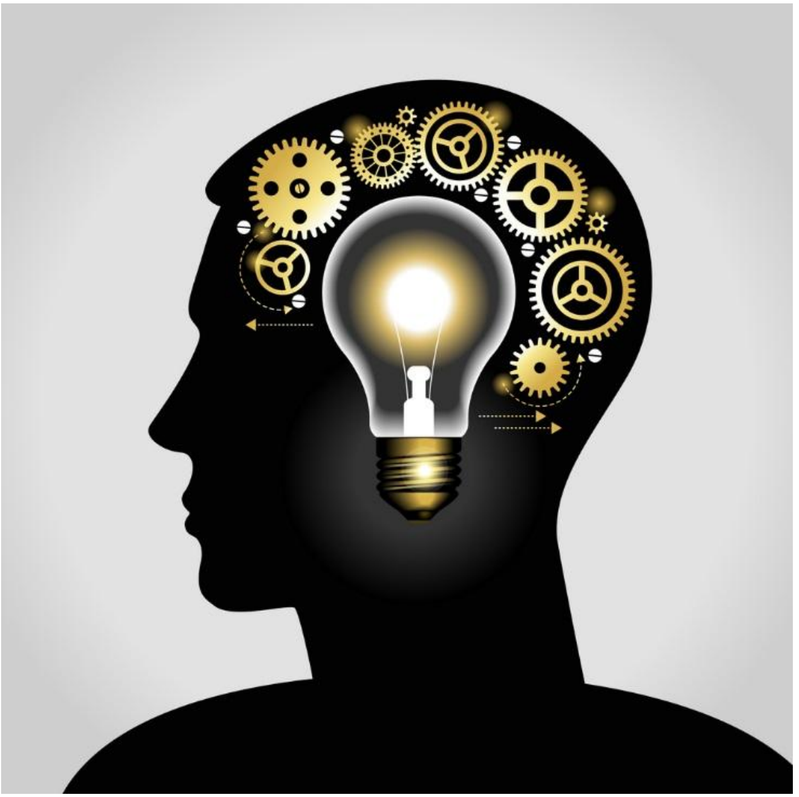
Intellectual

GHENT UNIVERSITY

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

What ? creations of the mind

intangible assets



Owners of Intellectual Property are granted

certain exclusive rights

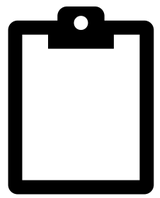


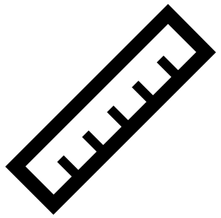


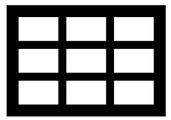
It gives you the right to say “yes” or “no”

GHENT UNIVERSITY

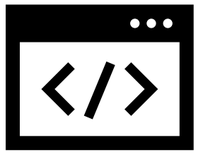
INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY (RIGHTS)

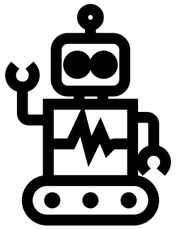

Survey


Measurement


Observation


Image


Code


invention


preparation





Databases





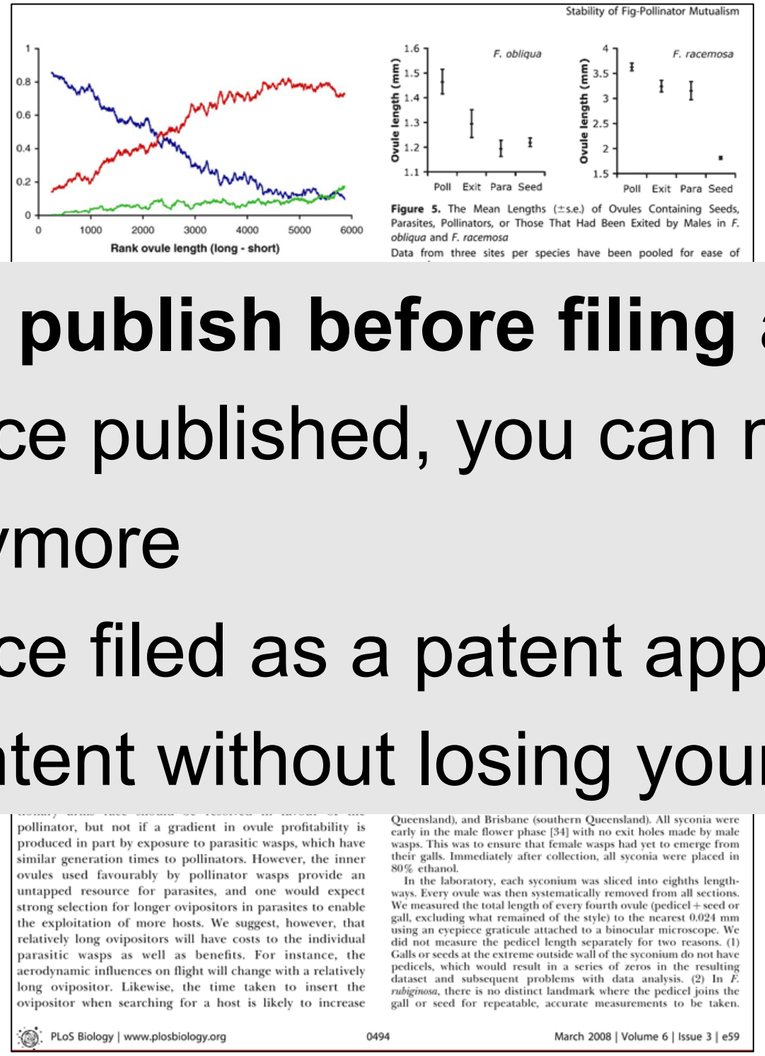


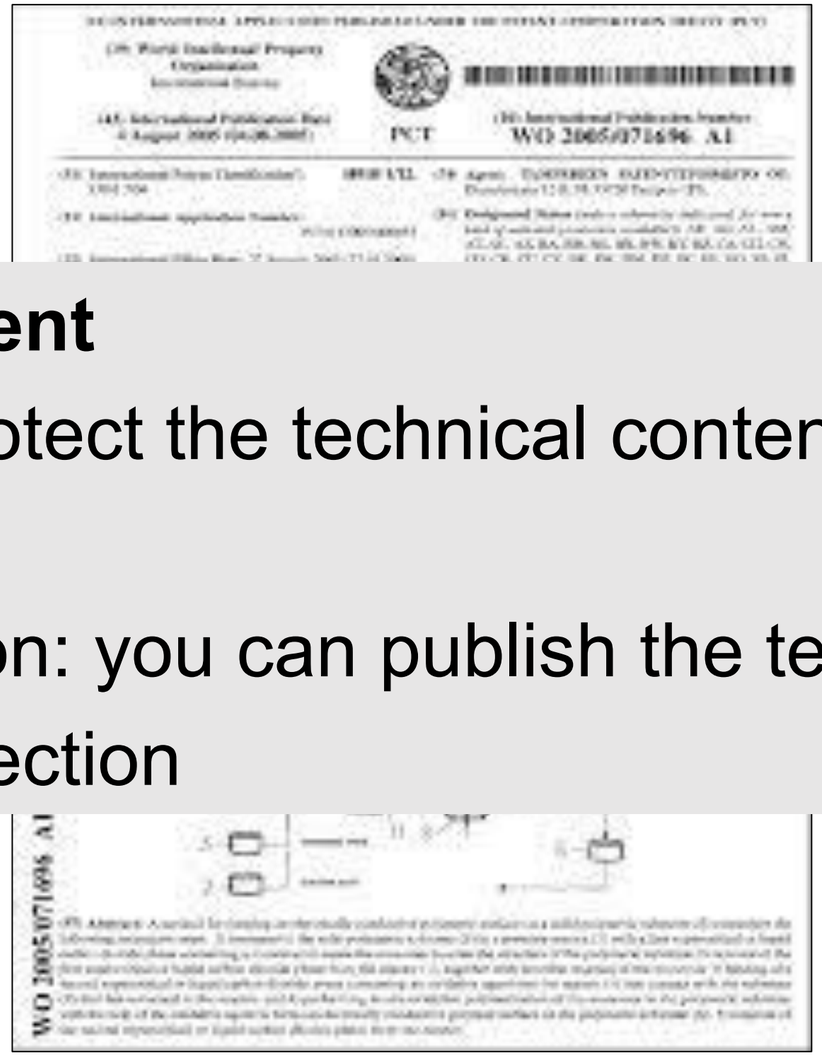
Patents

Trade Secret / Knowhow

GHENT UNIVERSITY

COPYRIGHT ←→ PATENT RIGHT





Don't publish before filing a patent

- Once published, you can not protect the technical content anymore
- Once filed as a patent application: you can publish the technical content without losing your protection

GHENT UNIVERSITY

Copyright: protects the way the content is described: no-one is allowed to copy the text

Patent right: protects the technical part of the content: no-one is allowed to make/use the technical invention

WHAT IS FTO?

"**Freedom to operate**": 3th party rights

copyright, c-database, c-software, patents, (knowhow)

Are you allowed to do what you want to do? Are you Infringing someone else intellectual property rights? Unauthorized use?

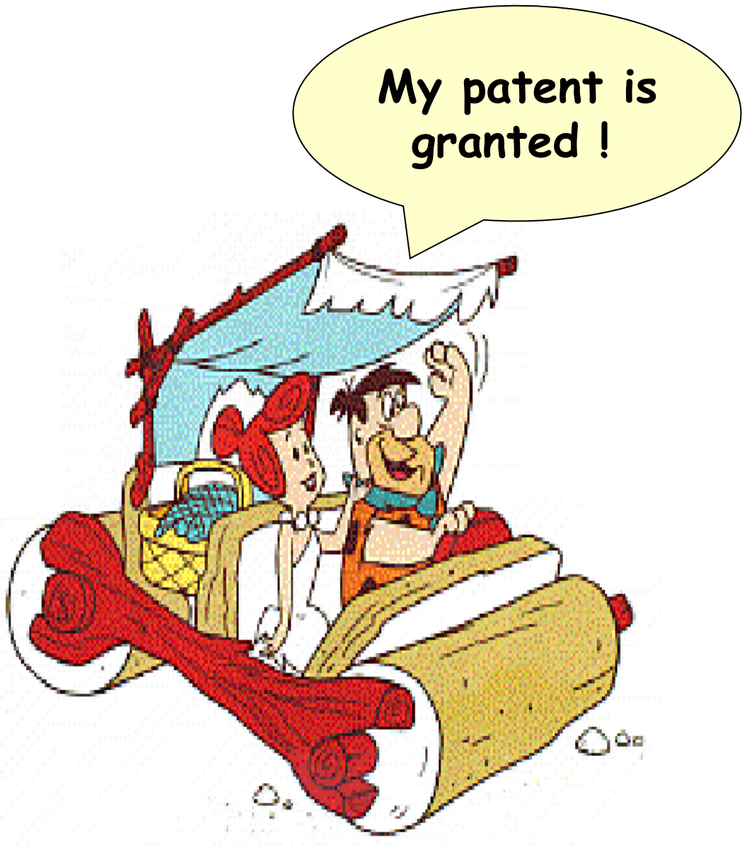
→ Can someone else say **NO** to you?

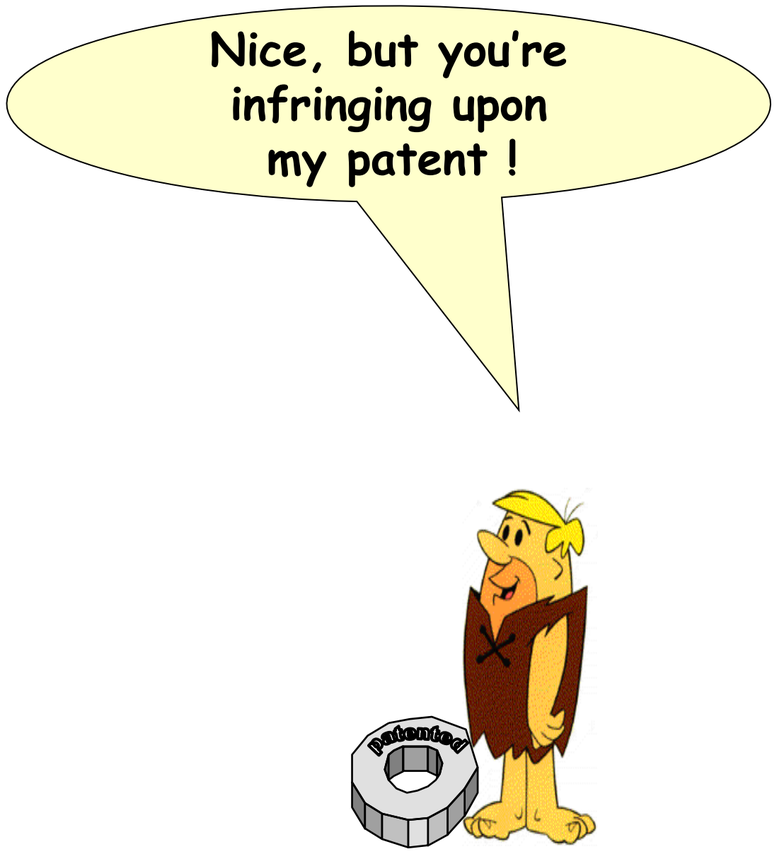
Example:

- Do you have the right software license? (academic/commercial)
- Are you allowed to use the external data or material? (DTA/MTA)
- Is there a patent that can block the valorisation of your project?

GHENT UNIVERSITY

FREEDOM TO OPERATE





GHENT UNIVERSITY

IPR STRATEGY IN SBO- PROPOSALS

DO'S AND DON'TS

GHENT
UNIVERSITY

BEFORE WRITING THE PROPOSAL

- Think about your tangible output (deliverables) and how you will keep them alive after your project

→ Someone in the advisory board, follow-up projects…?

Examples:

- Webpage with results, recommendations…
- Serious game, software tools…
- Smart database with valuable measureme
- Prototype, active ingredients, new materia





GHENT UNIVERSITY

IPR-REGULATION ON JOINT RESULTS







Shared ownership
Shared decisions

Partners valorise alone

One partner takes the lead in all results

Slower but more possibilities

Faster but less possibilities

Secure results in case of spin-off finality

GHENT UNIVERSITY

DO'S WHEN WRITING THE PROPOSAL

- Describe the IPR-regulation between the partners and **argue** why
- Mention how and if you will **protect** the results: patents, copyright or trade-secret (eg: on software), database rights...
- Mention how you look at **freedom to operate**: what databases/software platforms are you using: do you have the right license? Could 3th party's patents block you?
- Have the IP-rights transfered from the **subcontractant** (ICT/game)
- Mention how results will be transfered/licensed to organisations in the **advisory board** (open access / patent licenses / software or database licenses, seminars, workshops…)? Exclusive or non-exclusive?

DON'TS (OR BE CAREFUL)

- **Don't mention general statements (copy/paste)**

  Each partner will own their own results, jointly created results will be jointly owned…
  IPR-regulations will be discussed in the consortium agreement…

- Don't mention patents for non-technical research
- Don't publish before considering patent protection

Other recommendations:

- Avoid too less companies in the advisory board (5-20)
- Don't work on a company's (IP-) platform
- Avoid subcontracting an organisation that is a member of the advisory board
- Avoid scientific promotors who are also founders of spin-off companies that are members of the advisory board (*or describe how you will deal with conflict of interest*).

GHENT UNIVERSITY

THINK TWICE - SEEK ADVICE





Don’t write fancy things because they sound good…

Don’t copy/paste from other proposals, it might not fit your situation

GHENT UNIVERSITY

Questions?

Karen Curé
Business development
Grants

TECHTRANSFER

E karen.cure@ugent.be
T +32 9 264 99 64

GHENT
UNIVERSITY

TESTIMONIAL

Wendelien Vantieghem

Associate professor

Faculty of Arts and Philosophy

Department of Linguistics

Link to the testimonial

GHENT
UNIVERSITY

EVALUATION FUNDING ACADEMY DAY

GHENT
UNIVERSITY

INFO MARKET DURING LUNCH

- Lunch will be served in the Foyer or Kelder from 12:30 to 13:30
- At the entrance of the Foyer there will be an infomarket with Ghent University funding experts

Approach them with your questions!

Name	Team
	EU-team
	EU Education Project Funding
Karen Curé	National Research Funding
	Special Research Fund
Wim Van der Planken en Liesbeth Plovie	Fundraising and Relationship Management

GHENT UNIVERSITY